

In this tutorial, several design choices were implemented to come up with the static website that I built up. Key elements include the typography, structure and colour theory of the website. This essay will outline the elements, and how they were used to come up with the success of the website that was built.

When it comes to branding of an ecommerce platform, the font selection is important. Different fonts cater for different audiences. What's also important is that websites should combine typefaces. The two typefaces I combined were serif and sans serif fonts. I combined these typefaces to create visual hierarchy. The aim was to ensure the user knows the difference between heading and just a paragraph. Also, sometimes certain fonts are harder to read in long paragraph form. In an article in Evato, Balhki (2024) suggests that when combining fonts, it is important to ensure that they balance each other to avoid a confusing design. Hence if the design is not balanced, it can weaken the message and make it less effective. I opted for "Playfair Display" as my serif font. This gave the website a library atmosphere, which hence gives people a sense of familiarity as they are using a bookstore. This was combined with a sans serif font "Oxygen". This font is to make the website more modern and minimalistic. Hence improving its friendliness.

For colours, the main colours were vivid amber (#FFB433) and Light Grey (#CCC). The choice of light grey was to primarily be a neutral background and make the vivid amber stand out more. The vivid amber was also my call-to-action colour. This yellow colour evokes happiness and a welcoming atmosphere for users who use my website. I wanted to evoke these emotions because when I usually enter any bookstore in Cape Town I feel the same way.

To conclude, the design choices-font combination, colour scheme and structure-create a welcoming, user-friendly website. Reflecting the atmosphere of a typical physical Bookstore.

REFERENCE LIST:

Syed Balkhi (2024). *Combining Serif and Sans Serif fonts: How to Mix typefaces in your Designs:*

<https://elements.envato.com/learn/combining-serif-sans-serif-fonts>